Boston Sunday Globe

Serving our community since 1872

April 19, 2026

Ferry service tripped up again

Playing catchup on a costly, crucial upgrade

By Mike Damiano
GLOBE STAFF

There are a couple of reasons the Steamship Authority, which runs the ferries to Martha's Vineyard and Nantucket, might be motivated to spend a lot of money on a robust reservations system that won't freeze up the day tickets for the summer season go on sale.

One of them is named David Cox. He is a 66-year-old man in Elkhorn, Wis., and the Steamship Authority's current reservations system is almost completely dependent on him.

Cox built the system in 1996 and is the only person on earth who knows all the ins and outs of running it. What if, say, Cox met his maker a little ahead of schedule, a reporter recently asked James Malkin, a longtime member of the authority's governing board.

"Thank you!" Malkin exclaimed. "For six years, that's been ... the major risk that the Steamship Authority faces," he said. "It's a

FERRY, Page B10

Demobbed: Old gangster haunts fade in memory

Once notorious sites speak to city's shadowy history

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

SOMERVILLE — Where there was once bloody violence and criminal plotting, there is now preaching of salvation and grace.

The auto garage that once acted as the de facto headquarters for one of Greater Boston's most notorious organized crime outfits of the past century is now the Greater Works Church of God Somerville.

For a decade, this was the Winter Hill Gang's office for its gambling and loan-sharking business. It was at this address that James Sousa was killed in October 1974, after gangsters were worried he would cooperate with police following a botched rip-off of a local dentist in a fake gold bullion sale. Years later, one mobster, recalling that slaying, said "There was blood everywhere."

Like so many formerly gritty spots throughout the region, the building's interior has become something else entirely. It's dominated by a mural of people being baptized in a river, flanked by

MOB, Page A8

*"B****, I hope they blow your head off." • "I pray for all of you to get cancer." • You deserve to be hung until dead for treason. You worthless **** piece of **** • Oh man we're gonna put you all back in chains, we gonna put you back in chains (laughs) with all due respect. • "Maybe we'll have another shooter in this country ... and we'll put a ** bullet in his head, maybe his wife will get shot in the head, or maybe one of his kids" • "I will spend the rest of my ** life in federal prison to Make America Great Again by eliminating someone like you. I pray for your violent, bloody anguishing death, I pray your family is **** by the illegal aliens you coddle" • We are coming for you and when we do, we will find you. • Heavenly father, ... Turn their lives into living hell. Strip them of their peace, of the[...] ... we are going to stand every one of you m**********s in front of military tribunals. ... Those are death [...] • F*** you and everyone who works for you. Kill yourselves. • I pray to god that he gives you an incurable fatal case of AIDS with syphilis, so you can suffer a slow miserable death. • I hope you die a miserable death, [...]*

THE END OF NORMALCY

'We're coming for you.'

Threats to members of Congress are rising. They are more violent and more personal, and each feels like a real possibility.

By Tal Kopan and Jim Puzzanghera
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — The woman's voice on the phone message was steady and clear. "I am a proud American," she said. "I've got one thing to say ... [expletive], I hope they blow your head off."

In another, a man said in a calm, almost robotic tone: "We are coming for you and when we do, we will find you."

"I'm going to get next to one of your family members and have you feel some [expletive] pain," drawled another man.

Those excerpts, from three threatening voicemails left for different members of Congress, are far from isolated examples. In fact, threats such as these have become increasingly common, and congressional police, lawmakers, and staff operate with acute awareness that any one of them could become real.

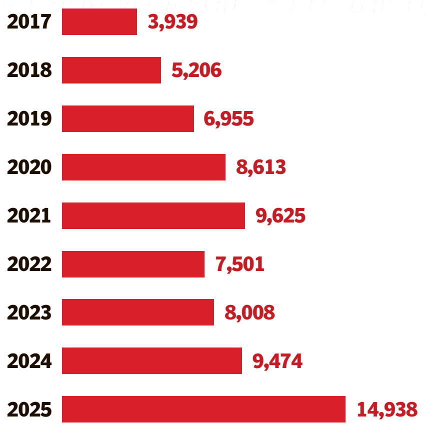
"I consider it to be one of my most important achievements as chief, keeping my boss alive," said a chief of staff to a New England lawmaker.

With the US Capitol Police investigating a significant jump in the number of concerning messages in 2025, the Globe asked the offices of more than two dozen House and Senate lawmakers from New England

THREATS, Page A6

Congressional threat cases rising

The US Capitol Police reported a big jump in 2025 in threat assessment cases investigating concerning statements, behaviors, and communications directed at members of Congress, their families, staff, and the Capitol complex. Cases this year are running ahead of that pace.



SOURCE: US Capitol Police
DAIGO FUJIWARA-SMITH/GLOBE STAFF

Tensions bubbling at UMass Amherst

Faculty, Reyes at odds as campus marks milestones

By Hilary Burns
GLOBE STAFF

As chancellor of the state's flagship public university, Javier Reyes keeps a busy schedule of campus appearances, donor courting, legislative appointments, and student meetings. But there is one thing Reyes forgot to do since taking the top job at the University of Massachusetts Amherst in 2023 — he did not, until this month, register to vote in Massachusetts.

The revelation, which first came up in a faculty senate meeting in late March, has reheated long-simmering tensions between Reyes and some faculty and staff. Many still harbor resentment over the chancellor's decision to call in police to break up a pro-Palestinian encampment in the spring of 2024 that resulted in about 130 arrests.

Embittered negotiations since then with some of the university's most powerful unions have further soured Reyes's reputation among a vocal cohort of the faculty. Several professors said that learning Reyes was not until recently registered to vote in Amherst after he was a candidate for a job at West Virginia University last year exacerbated concerns that he is not committed to UMass.

REYES, Page A9

The Independent Film Festival Boston is coming to town, and film critic Odie Henderson has suggestions. **SundayArts, N1.**

The standoff over the Strait of Hormuz escalated again as Iran reversed its reopening of the waterway and fired on ships attempting to pass, after the United States pressed ahead with its blockade of Iranian ports. **A2.**

When the heat was on, Fultz torched the field

Victor recounts 1976 Marathon 'Run for the Hoses'

Children in Newton held up sponges to Jack Fultz during the 1976 Boston Marathon. Fultz said "I stayed as wet as I could" during the race because of the heat of that day.

FRANK O'BRIEN/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

By John Powers
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Half a century later, Jack Fultz still has the laurel wreath, preserved and coppery behind glass. He also has the victor's medal, his Georgetown singlet, and the adidas shoes he bought a week before the race.

As well as the amusing memory, he said, of knowing something that the rest of the world wanted to know but didn't while he ran alone up front: Who *is* this guy?

He wasn't a mirage rising from the heat waves that scorched the pavement that afternoon in 1976. Fultz was an overlooked 27-year-old undergraduate who'd come to Boston hoping to achieve a qualifying time for that spring's US Olympic marathon trials.

He ended up beating the heat and the field on the hottest day in race history, when the mercury pushed 100 degrees and 40 percent of the field dropped out. "The Run for the Hoses" was "that fateful day that changed my life forever," Fultz later mused.

His sodden triumph established him as a top-level road runner, got him invitations to race on four continents, and led him to become the coach and adviser to Dana-Farber's Mara-

FULTZ, Page C13

Cloudy and sneezy

Sunday: Cloudy, rainy. High: 50-55. Low: 37-42.

Monday: Clouds and sun. High: 49-54. Low: 31-36.

Sunrise: 5:57 Sunset: 7:30

Complete report, **C24.**

Deaths, **C18-22.**

VOL. 309, NO. 109

*

Boost your savings with confidence.

GET A VARIABLE RATE UP TO

4.00% APY

for 6 months* on balances of $25,000–$10,000,000 with an Eastern Bank Money Market Plus

Earn up to 4.00% Annual Percentage Yield* with a 6-month interest rate boost. 180 days after account opening, the APY will revert to the standard, variable APY of up to 3.25%. Rates are subject to account balances.

Learn more at EasternBank.com/MoneyMarket or visit your local branch.

Eastern Bank
JOIN US FOR GOOD®

Balances	Standard APY*	Boosted 6-month APY*	Blended 12-month APY*
$10–$24,999	0.01%	0.74%	0.37%
$25,000–$10,000,000	3.25%	4.00%	3.62%
$10,000,000.01+	0.01%	0.74%	0.37%

*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is accurate as of 4/14/2026. This offer, interest rates, or APY are subject to change at any time without notice at the discretion of the Bank. Fees may reduce earnings. Minimum Deposit Requirement for opening account: $25,000 and must be new money not already on deposit with Eastern Bank. Offer limited to one account per taxpayer identification number. Please refer to the Personal Deposit Account Agreement for details.

Member FDIC.